

CW1 Workplace Charter

Statement of Purpose

This workplace charter sets out the framework for how Team 12 will collaborate, make decisions, and manage responsibilities. It defines standards for workflow, time and workload management, reporting, scheduling, inclusion, conduct, and safety. It guides interactions within the team and with university staff and provides a process for conflict resolution. It is an obligation that all team members subscribe to and will be used throughout the project to support fair, safe, and effective teamwork. This charter is a living document and may be revised as the project evolves. All changes will be recorded in the version history and communicated to the team.

Principles and Commitments

As a team, we will strive to uphold professionalism, respect, and integrity in all aspects of our work.

ED&I - We will commit to fostering an environment grounded in equality, equity, diversity, and inclusion. We will ensure that every member will have a voice, their opinion will be valued, and they feel fully included. We will champion the protection of all legally recognised characteristics—sex, gender identity, disability, ethnicity, religion or belief, sexual orientation, marital or transgender status, age, nationality, and neurodiversity—and reinforce the safety and wellbeing of every individual.

Collaboration - We will leverage each member's strengths, support one another's growth, and prioritise collective success over individual recognition. We will uphold transparency in workload and time management, meet deadlines reliably, and schedule meetings with fairness and flexibility. We will communicate openly, listen actively, and respond respectfully.

Safety - We will follow all safety protocols without compromise, and ensure our design decisions reflect reliability, performance, and feasibility.

Professionalism - We will maintain professionalism in all interactions—with teammates, instructors, GTAs, other teams, and the wider university—and address conflicts constructively. In cases of serious misconduct, including harassment, discrimination, or gender-based violence, we will escalate directly to the appropriate university department. We will hold ourselves accountable, seek feedback, share knowledge, and continuously improve. Through these commitments, we will build a safe, inclusive, and high-performing environment where collaboration, innovation, and technical excellence will thrive.

Team Rules

Section	Focus Area	Guidelines
Working Hours	A. Working Hours	i. Working hours are between 10am – 6pm, Mon–Fri, . ii. 5h asynchronous time per week. iii. Other times in urgent situations: safety risks, personal injury, severe equipment damage, irreversible delivery risks, etc.
Lab Attendance and Participation	B. Attendance	i. Mandatory for all scheduled lab sessions. ii. Notify team 24 hours in advance if unable to attend.
	C. Preparation	i. Arrive 15 minutes early to collect equipment and set up. ii. Complete pre-lab work (mechanical design and software control).
	D. Session Conduct	i. Follow all lab health and safety regulations. ii. Comply with all direction given by GTAs and staff.
	E. Rotating Responsibilities	i. Bring rover kit and return to storage. ii. Cleanup workspace. iii. Charge rover batteries.
	F. End-of-Session Protocol	i. Finish work at least 15 minutes before the lab session ends. ii. Use final 10 minutes to tidy up and verify inventory. iii. Use final 5 minutes to return the rover kit to storage. iv. Return the rover battery to the GTAs after each session.
	A. Response Times	i. General: within 24 hrs (work hours). ii. Urgent: as soon as possible, during work hours only.

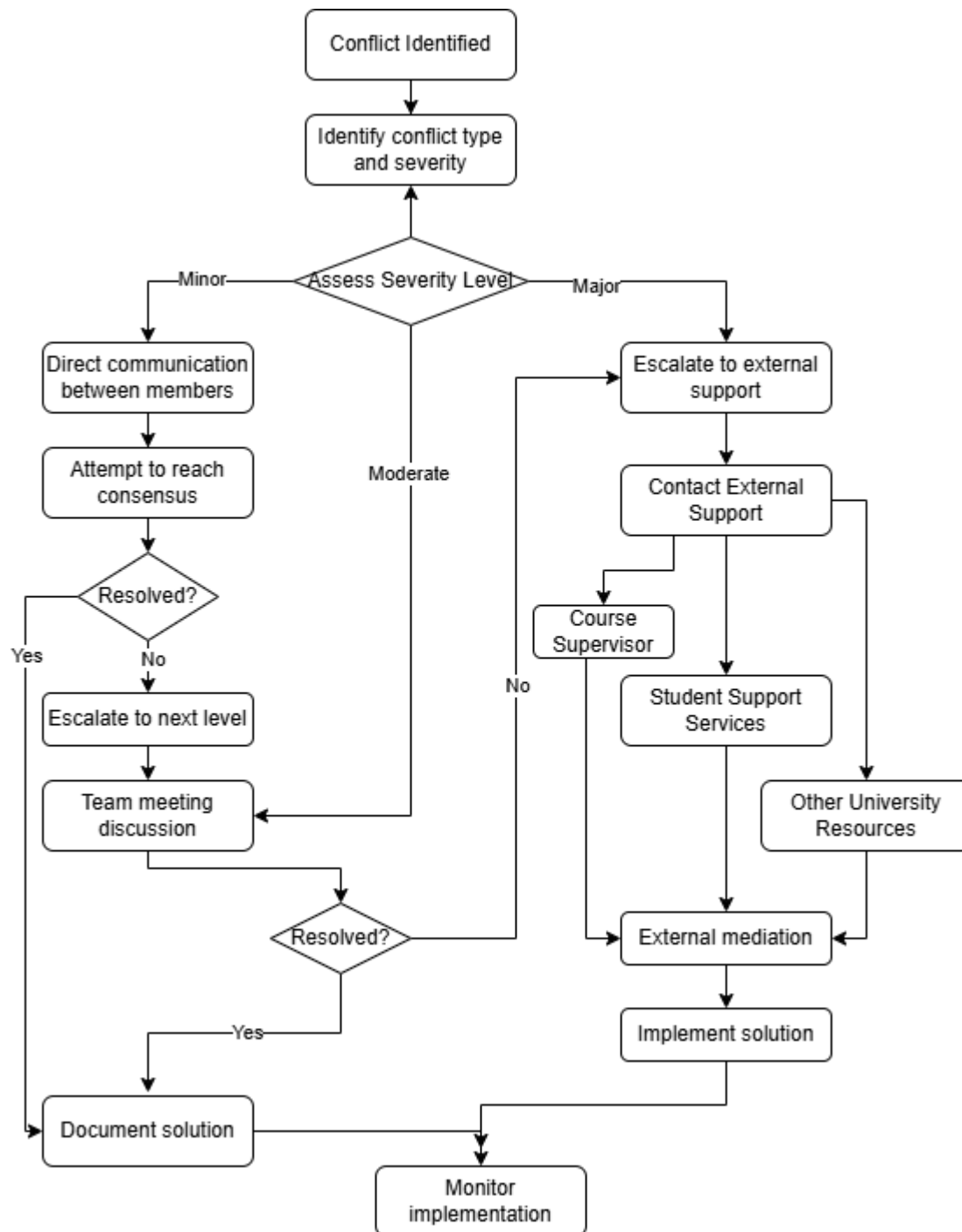
Communication and Language Standards		iii. Weekend: no response expected unless urgent.
	B. Channels	i. University Email and Microsoft Teams for formal communications, project discussion, meeting logs. ii. GitHub for code documentation, and version control.
	C. Language Use	i. Communicate in English across all platforms and meetings. ii. Support non-native speakers and encourage clarification. iii. Maintain clear, respectful, and inclusive language.
Decision-Making Process	A. Minor Decisions	i. Decide tool choices, formatting, and scheduling within sub-teams. ii. Inform full team via communication channels.
	B. Major Decisions	i. Discuss design choices, strategy, and major purchases in team meetings. ii. Aim for consensus with majority vote (minimum 80% team presence). iii. Document all decisions with rationale.
Work Allocation and Resource Management	A. Task Assignment	i. Assign tasks considering skills, workload, and learning opportunities. ii. Record tasks in GitHub-based shared task tracker or Teams channel post.
	B. Deadlines and Progress	i. Set internal deadlines 48 hours before external ones. ii. Share progress updates regularly (at significant milestones). iii. Notify team as soon as possible if unable to meet a deadline.
	C. Shared Resources	i. Borrow only tools and materials outside the provided kits. ii. Return borrowed items on time and report any damage or loss ASAP. iii. Keep a record of robotic kit inventory.
Quality Standards and Documentation	A. Code and Design	i. Follow agreed coding style guide (e.g., PEP 8 for Python). ii. Comment all code and include a README. iii. Submit code only after testing and peer review.
	B. Documentation	i. Log weekly (individual): work, time, issues, next. ii. Document all design decisions with rationale. iii. Organize Python and ROS files with clear naming conventions.
	C. Version Control	i. Write descriptive commit messages. ii. Require at least one approval for pull requests.
Wellbeing and Conflict Management	A. Wellbeing	i. Respect work-life balance; avoid working beyond work hours. ii. Support team members facing personal difficulties. iii. Take regular breaks during long work sessions to prevent burnout.
	B. Conflict Management	i. Adhere to Daily Activity Conflict Avoidance practices (below). ii. Comply with Conflict Resolution Flow Chart (page 3).

Daily Activity Conflict Avoidance

To avoid formal grievances, the Team will follow these daily practices:

- i. Three stand-ups a week to quickly note blockers, clarify ownership, reducing misunderstandings or duplicated work caused by delayed information.
- ii. Teams posts and a risk register visualise task status and potential issues, enabling the team to act before problems escalate.
- iii. Change request templates and a decision log prevent “verbal changes” or undocumented decisions, reducing later disputes.
- iv. Weekly Team Retrospectives with a closed feedback loop record mistakes and implement improvements, reducing recurring conflicts.
- v. Always talk first policy followed by tiered escalation process (private first, then team mediation, then tutor) provides a clear, fair order for raising concerns and prevents emotional public disputes.
- vi. Serious incidents should be reported immediately, and evidence preserved to protect affected individuals and support formal School procedures.

Conflict Resolution Flowchart



Links:

Report and Support - <https://www.reportandsupport.manchester.ac.uk/> - Hub for bullying, harassment, discrimination, gender based violence, hate or micro-aggressions, or safeguarding.

Student Support - <https://www.studentsupport.manchester.ac.uk/taking-care/> - Information on things you can do to look after your wellbeing and contacts in case of a crisis.